

AJAY SHARMA

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- **Results-driven Project Manager and Scrum Master** with **23+ years of experience** in **IT consulting, service delivery, and large-scale digital transformation** for global organizations. Proven ability to **lead Agile execution**, foster cross-functional collaboration and drive operational excellence to enhance customer satisfaction.
- **Skilled in Agile methodologies including Scrum, Kanban and SAFe**, facilitating **Sprint Planning, Grooming, Daily Stand-ups, Sprint Reviews, and Retrospectives** to optimize velocity, productivity, and delivery timelines.
- Expert in **Agile Project Management, Client Success, Delivery Excellence, and Continuous Improvement**, ensuring seamless execution of high-value initiatives while aligning strategy with business objectives.
- Achieved **significant cost and efficiency gains** (17% YoY Revenue & 74% YoY margin increase in 2024) by leading process optimizations, automation initiatives, and Agile transformations. Spearheaded workforce transformation, refining hiring, onboarding, and offboarding processes, resulting in enhanced resource quality and client satisfaction.
- Experienced in leading and scaling global engineering teams, leveraging offshore, nearshore, and hybrid delivery models to drive efficiency and innovation in high-velocity, complex software engagements.
- Proven expertise in driving full-stack digital solutions using GenAI, Salesforce, Java Spring Boot, Microservices, Cloud (AWS/Azure), DevOps, & modern CI CD pipelines to accelerate time-to-market and software reliability.
- Certified Scrum Master, Scrum Product Owner, and Project Management Professional with a strong commitment to Agile best practices, and continuous improvement across the SDLC.
- Industry expertise across Telecom, Logistics, Mortgage, Banking, Financial Services & Insurance, Retail, and Healthcare, ensuring project success in highly regulated and business-critical environments.

CORE SKILLS

- Agile Delivery (SAFe, Scrum, Kanban) | Scrum Ceremonies | Backlog Prioritization | Velocity & KPI Tracking
- Project, Program & Portfolio Management | Process Optimization | Delivery Excellence | Operational Efficiency
- Quality Engineering | CI/CD & DevOps Integration | Data-Driven Decision Making | Continuous Improvement
- Client Partnerships | Customer Value Creation | Digital Transformation | P&L Accountability | Revenue Growth
- Advanced Technologies: Generative AI | Salesforce | Microservices | Cloud Solutions (Azure, AWS)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Concentrix

Group Manager & Delivery Director

Nov 2021 – Dec 2024

Client (T-Mobile), a telecom giant provides wireless voice, messaging, and data services in the US mainland. Concentrix is helping with their digital transformation journey by designs pioneering experiences for the client & accelerating business outcomes through innovative and sustainable solutions using cutting edge technologies.

Job Duties:

- Accountable for the delivery of multiple strategic programs across geographies. Manage the technical, business and personnel aspects of the consulting engagements.
- Foster strategic relationships with key client stakeholders, understand and address their needs. Ensure digital solutions align with the client's growth strategy and business objectives.
- Provide strategic leadership to develop & execute plans to offer customized digital solutions to create value for the client. Stay abreast of industry trends, best practices, and emerging technologies, share insights internally.
- Engage in new opportunity identification, solution ideation, quality proposal creation and presentation.
- Evaluate business impact and value creation through profitability, account growth, and customer satisfaction.
- Build, mentor and guide several delivery & operations teams comprising of DMs, POs, PMs, SMs, Architects, Devs, QAs, DevOps, SREs & Ops engineers developing solutions across various technologies like Salesforce (CPQ, Vlocity, Copado), Java, Spring boot, Microservices, REST APIs, Angular, React, CI/CD & Azure DevOps.
- Foster a collaborative and innovative work environment by challenging, championing & celebrating our people.
- Lead workshops & stakeholder engagements to gather and document customer requirements, maintaining alignment with product vision and roadmap. Develop and maintain key project artifacts, including user stories, acceptance criteria, epics, feature roadmaps, and impact assessments to drive informed decision-making.
- Actively manage and refine product backlog, working with stakeholders to prioritize stories. Drive PI planning by setting sprint goals, defining release strategies, and ensuring teams are focused on high-impact deliverables.

Mphasis Corp.

Aug 2007 – Nov 2021

Project Manager & Scrum Master

Sep 2018 – Nov 2021

Client (FedEx) offers global transportation and business services. The Global Sort project collects, processes, and distributes core system (SEP/SEFS) data via a streaming service API to several downstream systems. This involved design & development of microservices applications on Java Spring Boot framework to consume core data from JMS queues, persist in Oracle DB, process and distribute data to downstreams across geographies (US, Europe, and APAC regions) to support global sorting of FedEx packages. These cloud native applications are deployed in PCF using Jenkins based CI/CD pipelines.

Job Duties:

- End-to-end ownership of cloud-native application delivery, ensuring alignment with business goals and technology roadmaps while collaborating with enterprise-level architects and stakeholders.
- Directly lead and mentor large, cross-functional teams including Business Analysts (BAs), Quality Engineers (QEs), Solution Architects, and Java Developers to drive successful project execution.
- Oversee microservices development leveraging Java, Spring Boot, SQL, Oracle DB, RESTful APIs, Git, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, and PCF (Pivotal Cloud Foundry) to build scalable applications.
- Conduct code reviews, test case peer reviews, and technical assessments, ensuring software quality and alignment with engineering best practices.
- Serve as a Scrum Master and Agile Coach, lead and facilitate key Scrum ceremonies, including daily stand-ups, sprint planning, sprint reviews, and retrospectives to foster collaboration and continuous improvement.
- Actively remove obstacles or blockers that may hinder the team's progress, ensuring that the team can focus on delivering high-quality work without interruptions.
- Identify and mitigate project risks, track project KPIs, and provide transparent reporting on sprint velocity, burn-down charts, and team performance.
- Track and report team progress, managing the sprint backlog, and helping the team improve velocity and efficiency through metrics-based feedback.

Test Manager & Project Lead

Apr 2010 – Sep 2018

Client (Fannie Mae) facilitates mortgage lending for affordable homeownership. The QAS project supports intensive testing of loan review web applications. The LQC Data Migration re-platformed existing applications.

Client (CapitalOne), a leading financial services company, offers credit cards, loans, and mortgages. The QAS-Data Analytical Testing team ensures data accuracy on mainframe and ETL platforms for strategic decision-making.

Client (AIG VALIC), a U.S. financial services firm, offers retirement products like annuities and mutual funds. This project focused on mainframe enhancements and bug fixes.

Job Duties:

- Lead and manage a mid-sized QA team, fostering collaboration with cross-functional teams (Development, Product & Business) to ensure high-quality deliverables.
- Develop, maintain, and execute robust quality engineering plans including test strategies, automation frameworks, test schedules, and comprehensive documentation of test artifacts.
- Conduct risk assessments and provide accurate effort estimations for both progression and regression testing.
- Facilitate peer reviews and lead technical walkthroughs with stakeholders to ensure end-to-end test coverage.
- Maintain requirements traceability through effective use of tools to validate business-critical functionality.
- Spearhead test automation initiatives to streamline regression testing and integrate automation into CI/CD pipelines, reducing release cycle times and increasing deployment frequency.
- Successfully led a data migration and re-platforming project for the QAS system, ensuring data integrity and system performance while meeting quality and delivery targets.
- Support NFR testing including system integration testing (SIT), performance testing, and (UAT).
- Tracking metrics such as defect leakage, test coverage, test execution, and automation effectiveness to drive data-informed quality decisions.
- Advocate for quality as a shared responsibility across the SDLC, collaborating with developers and operations teams to embed QE principles into every phase of delivery.
- Lead project initiation and transition planning, ensuring seamless execution from discovery to delivery.
- Build, train, and mentor offshore teams, fostering high performance and alignment with project goals.
- Monitor system stability, ensuring uptime and managing mainframe job execution on CA7 scheduler.
- Coordinate releases, managing pre-release and post-release activities with key stakeholders.
- Provide production support, monitoring batch runs, analyzing system failures, and implementing fixes.
- Manage application maintenance and enhancements, including test environment management and data creation.

Technical Project Manager

Aug 2007 - Apr 2010

Client (AIG) is a major player in insurance domain. Project catered development, enhancements, maintenance and production support on different platforms & technologies like mainframes, client servers, data warehouse etc. AIU Europe - Mainframe Support team provided support, maintenance, and enhancement of their premium & claims related business applications on mainframes.

Job Duties:

- Led production support operations, managing a mid-sized team of mainframe developers and testers.
- Handled project transitions, team training, documentation, and built a reusable knowledge repository.
- Monitored batch jobs and resolved production abends within SLA timelines.
- Overall test management, resource planning, and supported revenue forecasting.
- Implemented process improvements, maintained project metrics, and ensured smooth project closures.

Prior Experience:

- *Xansa India, now Sopra Steria India Limited (Jan 2004 – Aug 2007)*
- *Icon Data Management Limited (Apr 2001- Dec 2003)*

TECHNICAL SNAPSHOT

Management Tools	Workday, ICIMS, Azure DevOps, VersionOne (Agility), AGM, Visio, Project.
Tools	JIRA, Confluence, Figma, Salesforce, GenAI, Cloud (PCF, AW, Azure), Java, Spring Boot, Microservices, SOAP/RESTful APIs, XML, JSON, Postman, Swagger, (Open API Specification), Angular, React, Vue, Eclipse/IntelliJ, GitHub, Jenkins, CI-CD, Splunk, AppDynamics, qTest, Oracle, SQL, Notepad++, UNIX, Selenium WebDriver, Junit, Maven, TestNG, XML Spy, DataStax, MDM, HP ALM, HP Quality Center, IBM Rational DOORS, CA-Rally.
Databases	MongoDB, DataStax, Oracle 12C, Teradata, DB2, IMS.
Operating Systems	Windows11, IOS, UNIX, MVS OS/390 (Mainframes)
Other Skills/Tools	Tibco, Documentum, Autosys, IBM BPM/Lombardi, ClearQuest, Clearview, Ab-Initio, ETL/EDW testing, Teradata SQL Assistant, HTML. Mainframes-MVS OS/390, COBOL, JCL, DB2, IMS, DB2 Admin, CA-Endevor, CA-Panvalet, Changeman, File Manager, File Aid, ABENDAID, CA-7 Scheduler.
Business Domains	Telecom, Logistics, Mortgage, BFSI, Retail, Annuities & Healthcare.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Bachelor of Science, University of Rajasthan, India, 1998.

GNIIT, National Institute of Information Technology (NIIT), India, 2007.

Generative AI for Leaders (Vanderbilt University/Coursera)

Scrum Product Owner Certified (SPOC) – 2021 (International Scrum Institute)

Scrum Master Certified (SMC) – 2021 (International Scrum Institute)